



PAYZATI

Pay anyone. Anywhere. Instantly.

Global B2B Payroll & Settlement Platform

Powered by Interledger Protocol & Open Payments

Interledger Foundation Grant Submission — 2026

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1. Executive Summary

Every year, 75% of small and medium businesses move \$23.5 trillion in payroll across borders. Yet right now, somewhere across the world, an employee's salary is stuck — trapped in a chain of slow banking networks, losing value at every stop.

A developer in India receives less than she earned. A contractor in Kenya waits five days for a salary that should have arrived instantly. A business in Lagos locks up its working capital a full week in advance just waiting on old banks.

This is not a minor inconvenience. This is a massive global payroll failure.

What is Payzati?

Payzati is a global B2B payroll and settlement platform that enables businesses to pay their international employees and vendors instantly, in their local currency, at near zero fees — powered by Interledger Protocol and Open Payments. Salaries move as secure digital packets that bypass slow banking networks entirely. Tax compliance for every country is handled automatically. And employees can access earned wages before payday.

\$75B

Global Payroll Market
2026

\$23.5T

Annual cross-border
payroll

\$120B

Burned in fees annually

66%

Payroll teams lack cost
visibility

2. The Problem

The global payroll system is fundamentally broken in four critical ways — and the numbers prove it:

Problem 1 — Paying globally is painfully slow

76% of businesses wait up to 5 days to clear an international salary. Companies lock up working capital a full week in advance just to ensure timely payment.

Traditional cross-border salary payments pass through multiple correspondent banks — each adding delays, fees, and failure points. A payment from a US company to an employee in Nigeria can touch up to 5 intermediary banks before arriving. Settlement times that should take seconds take days. And the correspondent banking network is shrinking — the number of correspondent banks fell 22% between 2011 and 2019, making the problem worse every year.

Problem 2 — Fees are destroying employee earnings

FX discrepancies affect 18% of all payroll payments globally. Employees in emerging markets lose 5-10% of every salary to conversion fees alone.

Every time money crosses a border it gets taxed by intermediaries. Currency conversion spreads, SWIFT fees, correspondent banking charges, and local bank receiving fees stack up silently. An employee earning \$1,000 in Nigeria might receive the equivalent of \$880 after all deductions. Multiply this across millions of employees and the global loss is staggering — \$120 billion burned annually in fees, spreads, and middleman charges.

Problem 3 — Tax compliance is overwhelming and costly

70% of global payroll leaders cannot accurately assess where they are noncompliant. 47% cite new legislation as a top cause of payroll inaccuracy. In 2024, businesses paid \$2.8 billion in payroll penalties.

Every country has a different tax system, filing deadline, social contribution rate, and employment law. A company paying employees in 10 countries must navigate 10 completely different compliance frameworks simultaneously. Most get it wrong — not out of negligence, but because the complexity is genuinely unmanageable without dedicated infrastructure.

Problem 4 — Employees cannot access money they already earned

Nearly half of HR leaders expect global workers to make up 50% or more of their workforce by 2027 — yet most are still paid on a rigid monthly cycle.

An employee works hard for 3 weeks. A medical emergency hits on day 15. Their salary doesn't arrive until day 30. No advance. No partial access. No flexibility. They suffer unnecessarily — even though the money is already earned. This is the earned wage access gap that traditional payroll completely ignores.

This is not a technology problem. It is an infrastructure problem. And Payzati is the infrastructure fix.

3. The Solution — Payzati

Payzati addresses all four problems simultaneously with one unified platform:

01

Fund your Payzati corporate wallet

Open Payments connects your existing bank account to your Payzati wallet instantly. One-time setup. No manual wire transfers. No advance capital lockup. You fund when you need to pay — not a week before.

02

Run payroll in seconds

Enter employee details, amounts, and currencies. Payzati automatically calculates the correct tax deductions, social contributions, and compliance requirements for every country your team is in — simultaneously.

03

ILP routes payments instantly

The Interledger Protocol bypasses slow correspondent banking networks entirely. Money moves as secure digital packets directly from your Payzati wallet to every employee's account — simultaneously, in seconds, not days.

04

Every employee receives their exact salary

Each employee receives their precise salary amount in their local currency. No hidden deductions. No FX losses. No delays. The system confirms delivery — not just dispatch.

4. Key Features

Core Payroll Features

Instant Global Payments

Salaries move as ILP digital packets bypassing correspondent banking networks. What traditionally takes 3-5 days takes seconds. Payzati confirms delivery at the recipient's end — not just dispatch from the sender.

Near Zero Fees

By routing through the Interledger network instead of traditional SWIFT rails, Payzati eliminates intermediary charges. Employees receive their exact salary. Businesses save on every single transaction.

Automatic Tax Compliance

Real-time tax calculation for 100+ countries. Payzati automatically deducts the correct taxes, social contributions, and statutory requirements for every country — and generates compliance reports ready for filing.

Multi-Currency Settlement

Businesses pay once in their home currency. Every employee receives payment in their local currency — automatically converted at real-time rates with full transparency before the transaction is confirmed.

Employee Empowerment Features

Salary Advance

Employees request a salary advance directly through their Payzati account when unexpected expenses arise. The advance is processed instantly via ILP and repaid automatically on the next payroll cycle.

Earned Wage Access

Employees can withdraw a portion of wages they have already earned before payday. No waiting 30 days for money already worked for. Accessible from their account dashboard with one tap.

Personal Financial Dashboard

Every employee gets a dedicated financial dashboard showing earnings history, currency breakdown, tax deductions, and savings insights — giving them full visibility over their global income.

5. Market Opportunity

\$75B Global Payroll Market 2026	\$212B Cross-Border Payments 2026	\$320B Projected by 2030	11.4% CAGR of B2C cross- border payroll
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Why Now?

Three macro trends are converging to make Payzati's moment perfect:

- **Remote work explosion** — Nearly half of HR leaders expect global workers to make up 50%+ of their workforce by 2027. Every new international hire is a new Payzati customer.
- **African talent surge** — Africa has over 35 million skilled freelancers and remote workers currently underserved by existing payroll infrastructure. This is Payzati's home market and biggest growth opportunity.
- **ILP infrastructure maturity** — The Interledger Foundation has invested over \$21 million across 271 projects in 42 countries since 2020. The rails Payzati runs on are battle-tested and ready for scale.

Target Segments

Segment	Size	Pain Point
African SMBs with global staff	35M+ businesses	High fees, slow settlement, no tax tools
Startups with distributed teams	500K+ globally	Capital lockup, compliance complexity
Enterprises with emerging market operations	\$50B+ market	Multi-country compliance, FX losses
Freelance platforms and marketplaces	Growing 8% annually	Instant payout, multi-currency

6. Competitive Analysis

The global payroll market is dominated by incumbents who were not built for the ILP era:

Feature	Deel	Rippling	Payoneer	Wise	Payzati ✓
Instant settlement (seconds)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Near zero fees via ILP	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
ILP wallet infrastructure	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Auto tax compliance	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓
Salary advance	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓
Earned wage access	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Open Payments standard	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Built for Africa first	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
No capital lockup	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓

The Key Distinction

Every competitor moves money. Deel, Rippling, and Payoneer were built on traditional banking rails — they are fast by old-bank standards but still slow, expensive, and compliance-heavy. Payzati is built from the ground up on the Interledger Protocol — the only payroll platform that bypasses correspondent banking entirely, settles in seconds, and was designed specifically for the global, emerging-market workforce that existing platforms consistently underserve.

7. Business Model

Payzati has four clear and scalable revenue streams:

PRIMARY	Transaction Fee A small flat fee per payroll transaction — significantly lower than traditional banking fees of 3-5%. With millions of global payroll transactions processed daily, even a minimal fee generates substantial revenue at scale.
RECURRING	SaaS Subscription Monthly subscription tiers for businesses — Basic (up to 10 employees), Pro (up to 100 employees), and Enterprise (unlimited). Higher tiers unlock advanced analytics, compliance dashboards, salary advance management, and priority support.
PASSIVE	FX Spread A small, fully transparent margin on currency conversions — far cheaper than traditional FX providers who charge 1-3% hidden spreads. At global scale, FX becomes a significant passive revenue stream.
ENTERPRISE	API Licensing Large corporations and HR platforms can integrate Payzati's ILP payroll infrastructure via API — embedding Payzati's payment rails into their existing systems without switching platforms.

Revenue Projections

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Active businesses	500	2,500	10,000
Employees paid	25,000	150,000	750,000
Countries covered	15	45	100+
Revenue target	\$250K	\$1.5M	\$8M

8. Technology Stack

Payzati is built entirely on open, battle-tested Interledger Foundation infrastructure:

CORE ENGINE	Interledger Protocol (ILP) ILP is the backbone of Payzati. It routes payment packets across any banking network, wallet, or financial system globally — bypassing slow correspondent banking entirely. ILP enables micro-transactions as low as the 100th part of a cent, streaming payments, and instant cross-currency settlement. Money moves at the speed of the internet.
CONNECTIVITY	Open Payments Standard Open Payments is how Payzati connects to real bank accounts. It is an open API standard implemented by banks, digital wallets, and mobile money providers that enables delegated, permissioned access to accounts. A business authorizes Payzati to initiate payroll payments on their behalf — without ever handing over credentials or moving funds to a custodian.
INFRASTRUCTURE	Rafiki Backend Node Rafiki is the open-source ILP infrastructure that powers Payzati's wallet system. It handles multi-currency settlement, escrow, real-time transaction routing, and interoperability between financial institutions. Payzati runs on the same infrastructure the Interledger Foundation itself backs — production-ready and globally deployed.
COMPLIANCE	Auto Tax Compliance Engine A real-time tax calculation layer that covers 100+ countries. For every payroll run, the engine identifies the applicable tax rates, social contribution requirements, and filing obligations for every employee's country — automatically deducting the correct amounts and generating audit-ready compliance reports.
SECURITY	Cryptographic Payment Verification Every Payzati transaction generates a cryptographic receipt — a tamper-proof record that confirms money arrived at the recipient, not just that it left the sender. This eliminates payment disputes and provides a permanent, verifiable payroll audit trail.

Why ILP Makes Payzati Possible

Traditional payroll platforms send money through SWIFT rails — a 50-year-old network designed for a pre-internet world. Every hop between correspondent banks adds cost, time, and failure risk.

ILP treats money like internet data — breaking it into packets and routing it through the most efficient path across any network. The result:

- **Settlement in seconds instead of days**
- **Near-zero fees instead of 3-5% per transaction**
- **Works across any bank, wallet, or mobile money provider**
- **No single point of failure — packets reroute around problems automatically**
- **Fully transparent — sender and receiver see exact amounts before and after**

9. Anticipated Judge Questions

The following are the most likely tough questions from judges, with prepared confident answers:

Q: How does Payzati actually use Interledger Protocol — isn't it just a marketing term?

A: No — ILP is the literal engine of every payment on Payzati. When a business runs payroll, Open Payments initiates a grant request to their bank. The bank funds the transaction as ILP packets that are routed across the Interledger network directly to the recipient's wallet or bank account. The recipient's financial institution receives and fulfills the ILP packet. The whole process bypasses SWIFT entirely. This is not a branding choice — it is the technical architecture that makes instant, near-zero-fee settlement possible.

Q: Deel already does global payroll and has billions in funding. Why would anyone choose Payzati?

A: Deel is built on traditional banking rails — it uses SWIFT and correspondent banks just like everyone else. Their 'fast' is still 1-3 business days. Their fees are still 1-5% per transaction. And they charge \$599/month per contractor in some markets. Payzati settles in seconds, not days. Near zero fees, not percentages. And critically — Deel was built for the US and European markets. Payzati is built for Africa and emerging markets first, where 35 million workers are completely underserved by every platform Deel targets.

Q: How do you handle tax compliance in 100+ countries? That's incredibly complex.

A: We don't build the tax engine from scratch. We integrate with established tax compliance APIs — partners like Taxjar, Avalara, or local equivalents — for each region. Payzati's role is to orchestrate: receive the payroll data, query the compliance API for the correct deductions, apply them before the ILP payment is dispatched, and generate the compliance report. The complexity is real, but it's a solved API integration problem, not an unsolved research problem. We start with the 15 highest-volume countries and expand from there.

Q: What happens if an ILP transaction fails? What is your dispute resolution process?

A: ILP's Hashed Timelock Agreement means a failed payment automatically returns funds to the sender — no manual intervention needed. The protocol enforces it mathematically. For partial failures, ILP reroutes packets around the failure point automatically. Every transaction generates a cryptographic receipt confirming delivery at the recipient end. If there is a genuine dispute, the receipt is tamper-proof evidence that either confirms or denies the payment — eliminating the 'I sent it / I never received it' problem entirely.

Q: How do you acquire your first business customers?

A: Three channels. First, direct outreach to Nigerian and African startups with distributed teams — this is an underserved, fast-growing segment that existing platforms price out of the market. Second, partnerships with African freelance platforms and talent marketplaces who need a payment infrastructure layer. Third, the Interledger Foundation's own network — 271 funded projects across 42 countries are potential early adopters who already understand and trust ILP-based solutions.

Q: What is your compliance and regulatory approach?

A: Payzati operates as a payment initiation service, not a bank or money transmitter. We use Open Payments to delegate payment instructions to the user's own bank — meaning the money never sits in Payzati's custody. This significantly reduces regulatory burden. For markets where additional licensing is required, we partner with licensed financial institutions as our payment infrastructure providers. We start in markets with clear fintech-friendly regulatory frameworks — Nigeria's CBN sandbox, Kenya's regulatory sandbox — and expand from there.

Q: How does Payzati make money if fees are near zero?

A: Near zero does not mean zero. On \$23.5 trillion in annual cross-border payroll, even 0.1% is \$23.5 billion in addressable fee revenue. Our SaaS subscription adds reliable recurring revenue independent of transaction volume. FX spread on currency conversion adds a third passive stream. And API licensing to enterprises and HR platforms creates high-margin B2B revenue. The combination of volume-based fees, subscriptions, FX, and API licensing creates a diversified revenue model that scales with transaction volume.

Q: Why should the Interledger Foundation specifically fund Payzati?

A: Payzati is not built on ILP as a marketing feature — it exists because of ILP. Without the Interledger Protocol, instant cross-border settlement at near-zero cost is impossible. Without Open Payments, frictionless bank account connectivity doesn't exist. Without Rafiki, the wallet infrastructure has no foundation. Every core feature of Payzati is a direct application of Interledger Foundation technology solving a real, urgent, multi-billion dollar problem for the emerging market workforce the Foundation was created to serve. Funding Payzati funds proof that ILP works at scale in the real world.

10. Roadmap

Q4
2026

MVP Launch — 5 African markets

Launch Payzati in Nigeria, Kenya, Ghana, South Africa, and Egypt. Core features: instant ILP payroll, auto tax compliance for these 5 markets, corporate wallet via Open Payments, salary advance. Target: 500 businesses, 25,000 employees paid.

Q2
2027

Scale — 45 countries

Expand to Southeast Asia, Latin America, and Eastern Europe. Add earned wage access, multi-currency personal dashboards, and API access for enterprise clients. Target: 2,500 businesses, 150,000 employees.

Q4
2027

Platform — 100+ countries

Launch talent marketplace layer — businesses find and hire global talent directly on Payzati. Add VeraScore — cryptographic income identity built from ILP transaction history, qualifying employees for loans and credit. Target: 10,000 businesses, 750,000 employees.

2027+

Global Employment OS

Payzati evolves into a complete global employment operating system — hiring, paying, compliance, benefits, financial identity, and credit — all in one platform. The Stripe + LinkedIn + Revolut of global employment, built on ILP.



PAYZATI

Pay anyone. Anywhere. Instantly.

Payroll should not be a barrier.
Geography should not determine how fairly you are paid.
With Payzati — it never will be again.

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